The RPP Matrix

The RPP Matrix is a four-cell matrix that enables practitioners to analyze their intervention and program strategies in several dimensions, by looking at the different approaches of peace work, who is being engaged and what type of change is being sought.

Whom to Engage

In their studies, the RPP project found that all activities are based essentially on one of two approaches related to who needs to be engaged for peace:

More people approaches	Key people approaches
Peace needs support and participation of the general population. Aim to engage increasing numbers of people in actions to promote peace. Practitioners who take this approach believe that peace can be built if many people become active in the process, i.e., if "the people" are broadly involved. This may involve mobilization of larger constituencies or expanding the numbers of people committed to peace.	Peace cannot be achieved without involvement of certain people with major influence on the situation. Focus on involving particular people, or groups of people, critical to the continuation or resolution of conflict, due to their power and influence. "Key people" strategies assume that, without the involvement of these individuals/groups, progress cannot be made toward resolving the conflict. Who is "key" depends on the context: they may be political leaders, warlords, or others necessary to a peace agreement. They may be people with broad constituencies. Or they may be key because they are involved in war making (e.g., unemployed young men).

Types of Change

The RPP project also found that all activities work for two basic kinds of change:

Individual/personal change	Socio-political change
Programs/interventions that work at the individual/personal level seek to change the attitudes, values, skills, perceptions or circumstances of individuals, based on the underlying assumption that peace is possible only if the hearts, minds and behavior of individuals are changed. Most dialogue and training programs operate at this level, working with groups of individuals to affect their skills, attitudes, perceptions, ideas and relationships with other individuals.	Programs/interventions that concentrate at the socio-political level are based on the belief that peace requires changes in socio-political structures and processes, often supporting the creation or reform of institutions that address grievances that fuel conflict, or promoting non-violent modes for handling conflict. Change at this level includes alterations in government policies, legislation, policies, economic structures, ceasefire agreements, constitutions, etc. But it also incorporates changes in social norms, group behavior, and inter-group relationships.

The RPP Matrix

	More people strategies	Key people strategies
Individual/personal change		
Socio-political change		

Key findings

- Efforts that stays within any one quadrant of the matrix is not enough to build momentum for significant change.
- Efforts that focuses on change at the Individual/Personal level, but that never links or translates into action at the Socio-Political *level has no discernible effect.*
- At the Socio-Political level, efforts that concentrate on More People but do nothing to link to or affect Key People, as well as strategies that focus on Key People but do not include or affect More People, do not “add up” to effective work.

Worksheet

Program/intervention goal:		
	Proposed/Completed Program Activities	Actual/Expected Changes, due to Activities
1.		
2.		
3.		
4.		
5.		
6.		
7.		
8.		
9.		
10.		

Task

1. Using worksheet, describe your work in terms of activities you do and the result/change you expect.

2. Place the activities in the RPP Matrix:
    a. First locate the program goal on the Matrix. Is the goal at the Individual/Personal or Socio-Political level of change? More People or Key People?
    b. Take the first activity and the associated change: where do you find the activity on the Matrix? Where is the resulting change?
    c. Continue to map activities and changes until you come to the end of the current program steps (in the case of an existing program) or the proposed steps (in the case of a prospective program in planning).
    d. 4. Do the activities/changes add up to the desired change (goal)? Are there any gaps?

3. Describe what you need to do to effect change on socio-political level (or what you are already doing)

Reflections

1. What insights have you gained regarding your own program/intervention?

2. What challenges are raised?

3. Are there additional linkages you might consider—either within your own program/intervention or with other efforts?

4. Going forward, what do you want to think about more? What changes might be needed to make your program/intervention more effective?